

CDC and ACOG Urgent Maternal Warning Signs and Emergencies:

1. Severe Bleeding:

Bleeding that saturates a sanitary pad in an hour or passing blood clots larger than a quarter requires immediate emergency medical evaluation.

2. Severe Abdominal or Chest Pain:

Sharp, sudden, or persistent pain in the chest, breathing difficulties, or severe cramps in the stomach/abdomen can indicate emergencies like pulmonary embolism, ectopic pregnancy, pre-eclampsia, or placental abruption.

3. Pre-eclampsia Flags:

Sudden severe swelling of the face, hands, or eyes, accompanied by a persistent splitting headache, blurry vision, flashing lights, or pain in the upper right abdomen.

4. Reduced Fetal Movement:

A significant decrease or sudden stoppage of baby movement (fewer than 10 kicks in 2 hours) in the third trimester requires immediate fetal monitoring at a clinic or hospital. Do not wait for the next day.

5. Loss of Consciousness or Seizures:

Any fainting spells, extreme dizziness, or seizures require calling an ambulance immediately.